CELPIP TEMPLATES · WRITING TASK 1

The Email

27 minutes · 150–200 words
Elevate with Ms. Maria · Learnovate Qatar

YOUR 27 MINUTES
3 min plan · **20 min** write · **4 min** proofread

THE GOLDEN RULE
One paragraph for **each bullet**, in the same order as the prompt.

CHECK THE READER
Manager / company / landlord → **formal**
Neighbour / colleague → **semi-formal**
Friend / family → **friendly**

Template · Formal email

Dear Mr./Ms. _____ / Dear Customer Service Manager,

PURPOSE I am writing to _____ (complain about / request / inform you about) _____.

BULLET 1 On _____, I _____. Unfortunately, _____.

BULLET 2 As a result, _____. This has been very _____ (inconvenient / stressful / costly) because _____.

BULLET 3 I would appreciate it if you could _____. Alternatively, _____ would also be acceptable.

CLOSE Thank you for your attention to this matter. I look forward to hearing from you soon.

Sincerely,
_____ (your full name)

Template · Friendly email

Hi _____!

I hope you're doing well. I'm writing because _____.

BULLET 1 First of all, _____.

BULLET 2 Also, _____. You'll love it because _____.

BULLET 3 If you like, I could _____. Just let me know!

Can't wait to see you. Take care,
_____

Template · Semi-formal email

Hi _____,

My name is _____, and I live in _____ / I work in _____.

BULLET 1 I wanted to let you know that _____.

BULLET 2 I'm afraid this means _____.

BULLET 3 Would it be possible to _____? I'm happy to help with _____.

Thanks so much for understanding.
Best regards,
_____

PHRASES THAT SCORE
Explain: Unfortunately, … · To make matters worse, … · As a result, …
Feelings: I was very disappointed … · This was extremely inconvenient …
Request: I would appreciate it if … · Would it be possible to …?
Close: Thank you for your understanding. · I look forward to your reply.

MODEL (FORMAL, BULLET 2)
As a result, I had to sit on the floor for two weeks while I waited for a replacement. This was extremely **inconvenient** because my parents were visiting, and we had nowhere comfortable to sit.

Each bullet paragraph = **2–3 sentences**: a detail + a reason or example.

CELPIP TEMPLATES · WRITING TASK 2

The Survey Response

26 minutes · 150–200 words
Choose ONE option and defend it

YOUR 26 MINUTES
1 min choose · **3 min** outline · **18 min** write · **4 min** proofread

HOW TO CHOOSE
Pick the option with **more and easier reasons**, not the one you prefer.

NEVER
Never choose both. Never stay neutral. Two developed reasons beat five short ones.

Template · 5-part survey response

1 · POSITION In my opinion, Option ___, _____, is the better choice for _____ (our city / our company / families).

2 · REASON 1 First, _____. For example, _____. As a result, _____.

3 · REASON 2 Another important reason is that _____. In my experience, _____.

4 · CONCESSION Admittedly, Option ___ would _____. However, _____.

5 · CONCLUSION For these reasons, I strongly believe that _____ is the wiser choice.

Model · "A dog park (A) or a community vegetable garden (B)?"

In my opinion, Option B, a community vegetable garden, is the better choice for our neighbourhood. **First**, a garden brings neighbours together. **For example**, in my last city, families met every Saturday to plant and water, and many became close friends. **As a result**, the street felt safer and friendlier.

Another important reason is that a garden helps families save money. Fresh tomatoes and herbs are expensive, and growing them teaches children where food comes from.

Admittedly, a dog park would give pets a safe place to run. **However**, it would serve only dog owners, while a garden is open to everyone, including seniors and children.

For these reasons, I strongly believe that a community garden is the wiser use of the space.

PHRASES THAT SCORE

Position: In my view, … · I strongly support Option …
Reasons: First, … · Another key reason is … · Moreover, …
Examples: For example, … · In my experience, … · For instance, …
Concession: Admittedly, … However, … · Although …, …
Conclusion: For these reasons, … · Overall, …

GROW A THIN REASON

Reason → buses help people get to work
Example → my neighbour takes two buses for 80 minutes
Result → so she is often late and tired
Contrast → a direct route would cut her trip in half

Proofread: clear position · 2 reasons with examples · concession · 150–200 words.

CELPIP TEMPLATES · SPEAKING

Speaking Tasks 1–8

About 15 minutes · 8 tasks
Use all prep time · keep talking until the clock stops

PREP NOTES
Write **3 key words**, not sentences.

OUT OF IDEAS?
Add an **example** or a **reason**, or summarize your main point.

LAST 10 SECONDS
Close clearly: "So my advice is…" / "That's why I think…"

Task 1 · Giving Advice

30 s prep · 90 s speak

Hi _____, I understand that _____ is a tough decision.

One option is to _____. This would help you _____ because _____.

Another idea is to _____. That way, you could _____.

If I were you, I would _____, because _____. Good luck!

Task 2 · Personal Experience

30 s · 60 s

WHEN + WHERE About _____ ago, when I was _____ in _____, …

WHAT HAPPENED First, _____. Then _____. Finally, _____.

FEELING At first I felt _____, but later I felt _____.

LESSON Since then, I always _____.

Tell the story in the **past tense**: went, saw, felt, decided.

Task 3 · Describing a Scene

30 s · 60 s

This picture shows _____ (a busy park / a kitchen) on _____.

In the **foreground**, a _____ is _____-ing _____.

In the **middle**, I can see _____.

In the **background**, there are _____. Overall, the mood is _____.

Task 4 · Making Predictions

30 s · 60 s

The _____ is _____, so he/she will probably _____.

I can see _____, so it might _____.

Because _____, I think _____ is going to _____.

Each prediction = a **clue** from the picture + **will probably / might / is going to**.

Task 5 · Comparing & Persuading

60 s choose · 60 s prep · 60 s speak

I know you like _____, but I really think _____ is the better choice for us.

First, it _____, so we can _____.

Not only that, but it also _____.

I see why _____ is attractive, but it _____. Don't you agree?

Task 6 · A Difficult Situation

60 s · 60 s

Hi _____, I know how important _____ is to you.

Unfortunately, _____, because _____.

I'm afraid I can't _____, but what if we _____?

Or I could _____. Would that work for you?

Speak **to** the person ("you"). Empathy → explain → offer a solution.

Task 7 · Expressing Opinions 30 s 90 s

In my opinion, _____. / I strongly agree that …

The main reason is that _____. For example, _____.

Another reason is that _____. I remember when _____.

That's why I believe _____.

Task 8 · Unusual Situation 30 s 60 s

Hi _____, I just saw the strangest _____, and I had to tell you about it.

It's shaped like _____, about as big as _____.

It's made of _____, and it's _____ (colour).

On the _____, there is _____. It looks a bit like _____.

Describe it as if your friend is **on the phone** and cannot see it.

RECOVERY PHRASES (ANY TASK)

Let me put it another way… · What I mean is… · For example… · The thing you use to… (when you forget a word) · So, to sum up…